

Ellis Data Caliber Specification

Version 3 September 2026 · Deliverable No. 10 · The same calibers govern the live pages and the Excel export

1. The 25-field dictionary

One record is one visa product for one passport, destination, purpose and document type. A route with several products yields several records. The export and the pages share one field set plus one refinement column. Twenty fields are required and five are provided if available, as the requirements specification states.

#	Field	Required	Caliber
1	travel_document_type	Required	The document held, one of 13 types: ordinary passport, diplomatic passport, service passport, official ordinary passport, PRC travel document, temporary passport, emergency passport, child passport, alien's passport, stateless travel document, laissez-passer, identity certificate, refugee travel document.
2	travel_document_country	Required	Issuing country, ISO alpha-3.
3	destination_country	Required	Destination country or territory, ISO alpha-3.
4	travel_purpose	Required	Tourism, business, family visit, study, work, transit, other.
5	visa_requirement	Required	Top-level class: visa-free, visa on arrival, visa required in advance. About 181 records use a fourth value, Conditional. See section 5.
5a	visa_requirement_detail	Extra	Refinement nested under the top-level class. Visa-free: unconditional, conditional, transit. On arrival: electronic on arrival, paper on arrival. In advance: eVisa, paper visa, electronic travel authorization. A test guarantees that every detail belongs to its parent class.
6	visa_type_name	Required	The destination's product name for this purpose, in official naming.
7	validity_duration	Required	How long the visa is valid once granted, as a number. Where the government only says "at the mission's discretion", the record says so.
8	validity_unit	Required	Days, months, years, or indefinite.
9	max_stay_duration	Required	Longest stay per entry, as a number.
10	max_stay_unit	Required	Hours or days.
11	entries	Required	Single, multiple, or unlimited. Where the issuing authority decides case by case, the record says so.

12	processing_min_days	If available	Shortest time from submission to decision, as a number.
13	processing_unit	If available	Working days or calendar days.
14	visa_fee_amount	Required	The official visa fee only, charged by the mission. Agency service fees are excluded and disclosed separately in the application channel note.
15	visa_fee_currency	Required	ISO 4217 currency code.
16	application_method	Required	Embassy or consulate, online, through an appointed agent, on arrival, or in person at the issuing government office for a domestic permit such as the mainland Exit-Entry Permit for Hong Kong. "Other" is never used. An appointed agent is named only where the destination mandates one, for example Chinese citizens applying for Japan.
17	required_documents	Required	The core document categories, comma separated.
18	consulate_district	If available	The consular district mapping, where the destination divides applicants by residence.
19	entry_requirements	If available	Entry conditions beyond the visa, for example a return ticket or an arrival card.
20	special_conditions	If available	Special policies or limits, for example regional exemptions, transit exemptions, or exemption for holders of a third-country visa.
21	data_source	Required	Name of the issuing institution.
22	source_url	Required	The specific official page. The code enforces a government domain, so a non-official link cannot be written. Where several sources are cross-checked, each carries its own URL and all are shown on the record.
23	collected_at	Required	The date the answer was produced or last refreshed.
24	info_validity	Required	See section 5. Current caliber: the date until which Ellis guarantees the answer. Where a policy carries its own end date, that date governs.
25	confidence_level	Required	High, medium, or low. See section 4.

2. The three kinds of blank

A blank cell is never ambiguous. It is one of three kinds, stated on screen and in the export:

Kind	Display	Counted in the completeness denominator
Not published	"Not publicly available". The official page was checked and publishes no value for this item.	Excluded from the fillable caliber
Does not apply	"Does not apply to this route". For example, a visa-free route has no visa validity.	Excluded from the fillable caliber

Missing	"missing". Research not yet complete. This is open work.	Counted, and lowers completeness
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3. Completeness calibers

Completeness is stated two ways, and both are shown on the completeness tile.

First, the cell caliber of section 6.1: filled cells over required cells. The fillable reading excludes not-published and does-not-apply cells and shows how many were excluded. The literal reading counts every cell.

Second, the record caliber of section 4.2.2: records with all 25 fields filled divided by all records.

The gap is structural: a correct visa-free record cannot fill fee or validity, and section 4.2.1 forbids inventing what no government publishes. Which caliber governs acceptance is for the joint meeting.

4. The confidence ladder

Grade	Rule (per 4.2.3)	Handling
High	A person verified the record against a named official page, and the record is complete with no conflicts.	Shown
Medium	Backed by an official source, with a few fields still to fill, or fields the government does not publish.	Shown, with the source attached
Low	Sources conflict, or only non-official sources exist, or a specific product and fee is claimed without a read of the official page.	Held. Readers see "We are checking this route" until an operator confirms it

Grading is automatic. A hold is released only by a fact verified against an official source or by an audited operator release.

5. Calibers awaiting a joint ruling

Three calibers need the joint meeting's ruling:

First, `info_validity`. The dictionary reads it as the policy's own end date, which most governments do not publish. Where a policy has an end date it is used (the Korea group exemption to 31 December 2026). Otherwise it is the date by which Ellis must re-check the answer, and the export says so.

Second, the fourth value of `visa_requirement`, Conditional. About 181 records depend on the traveler's own circumstances, such as holding a valid third-country visa. They can

be folded into the "visa-free, conditional" detail. The migration script is ready.

Third, the completeness caliber, see section 3.

6. Special policy notes

Regional and transit exemptions live as standalone notes bound to an official URL: Hainan's 30-day exemption for 61 nationalities, China's 240-hour transit exemption, and the Korea group-tour and Jeju policies. Notes appear beside relevant routes, on the display pages and in the AI Q&A, with a covered-or-not line whenever the nationality is known.

7. Export caliber

The export is an .xlsx workbook: a data sheet with field names in the first row and a field description sheet with each caliber and the UTC snapshot time. It is the online data through the same code path, with no row cap.

Any caliber change updates this document and the export's description sheet before it takes effect.